VHEMBE DISTRICT MUNICIPALITY
PROJECT CLOSE-OUT REPORT

Project By: Zimako Smart Business Solutions



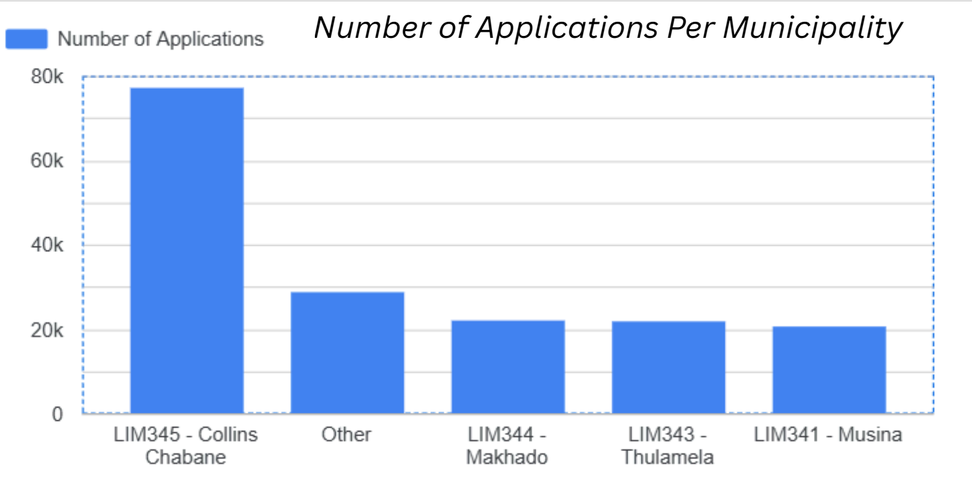
Verification Outcomes - Three Year Analysis

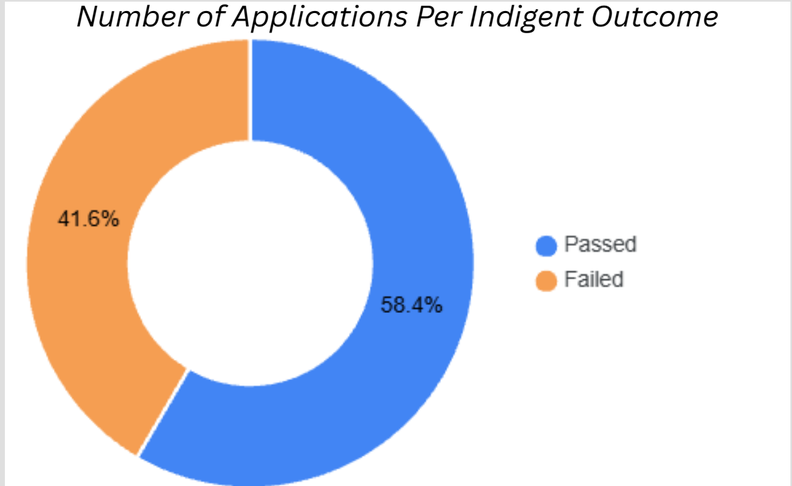
1) Applications Per Municipality:

- There was a total of 170 091 records, But there are 141 395 records within the our four minicipalities:
  - **Collins Chabane** Local Municipality has the **highest** number of records within Vhembe District, with 77 124 applications
  - **Makhado** Local Municipality has the second highest number of records within Vhembe District, with 21 970 applications
  - **Thulamela** Local Municipality has the third highest number of records within Vhembe District, with 21 762 applications
  - **Musina** Local Municipality has the lowest number of records within Vhembe District, with 20 539 applications

2) Indigent Application Outcomes:

- 99340 applications were approved to be indigent**,** while 70751 applications were declined to be indigent





3) Deceased Applicants Analysis:

- 157 529 applicants are still alive, while 12 562 of our applicants have deceased

4) Child-Headed Households Analysis:

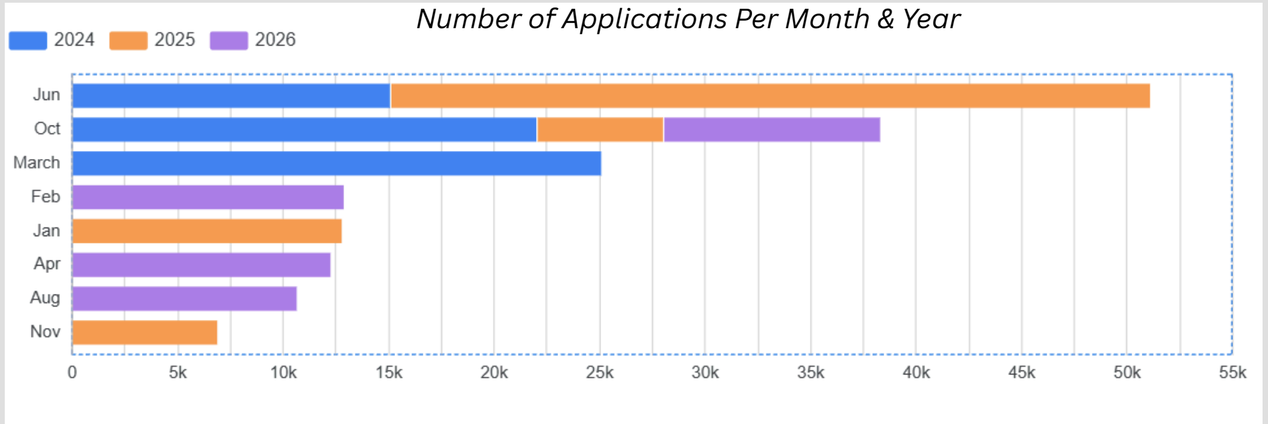
- Only 36 households are child-headed households, the rest are adult applicants
- Link to child-headed households: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Df670QsR8eqMby2JCGzFQsH8xXynYkss/view?usp=drive_link

5) Multiple Account Indigent Applications:

- 52 365 applicants were found to have multiple accounts in the indigent application dataset

6) Indigent Outcome Per Year:

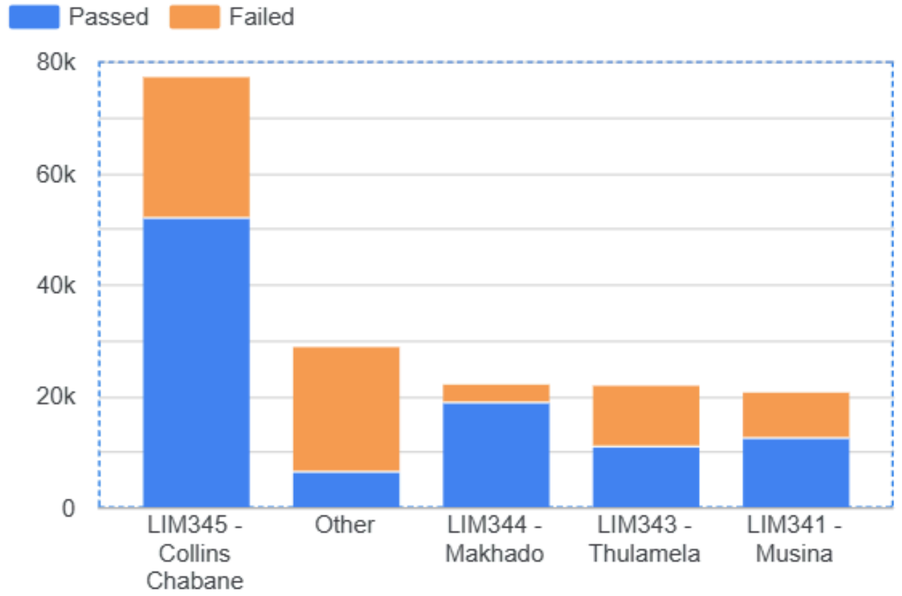
- 67.44% of the applications were approved as indigent in year 2024
- 35.6% applications were approved in 2025
- and 76.73% applications were approved in 2026
- The most number of applications were made during June 2025, followed by March 2024



7) Indigent Outcomes Per Municipality:

- **Makhado Local Municipality:** 84.57% applications were approved as indigent
- **Musina Local Municipality:** 59.45% applications were approved as indigent
- **Thulamela Local Municipality:** 49.11% applications were approved as indigent
- **Collins Chabane Local Municipality:** 67.04% applications were approved as indigent

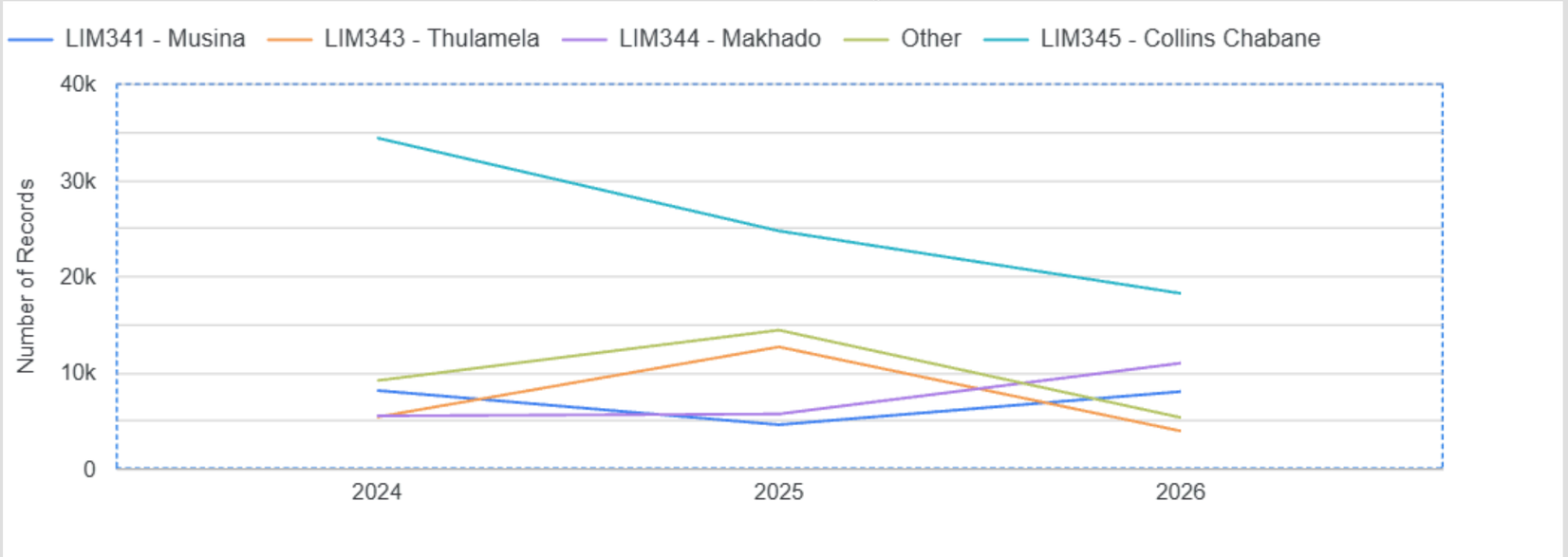
Applications Per Municipality & Outcome



8) Applications Per Year & Municipality:

- Collins Chabane Local Municipality had its highest number of applications in 2024
- Thulamela Local Municipality has its highest during 2025
- Makhado Local Municipality had its highest in 2026
- Musina Local Municipality had peak applicants both in 2024 and 2026

Applications Per Municipality & Year



Application Segmentation & Risk Analysis

1) Income Buckets Analysis:

- A majority of our applicants (48.88%) recieve an income between R0 & R2 500
- 23.61% applicants did not fill in their details about their income

2**) Accounts that Own Properties:**

- Only 3.5% of the applicants own more than one property
- About 13.55% applicants own just one property
- 46.69% Do not own properties at all
- The rest of the 36.30% applicants are unknown / did not fill in the information

Table 2: Applications Per Property Ownership

Property Category	Applicants	Percentage
No properties	79412	46.69%
Not recorded	61742	36.30%
1 property	23046	13.55%
More than 1 property	5891	3.46%

Table 1: Applications Per Income Bucket

Income Buckets	Total Applicants	Percentage
R0 - R2 500	83143	48.88%
Unknown	40151	23.61%
R2 500 - R5 000	28778	16.92%
R5 000 - R10 000	12117	7.12%
R10 000 - R20 000	3884	2.28%
R20 000 - R30 000	1108	0.65%
R30 000 - R40 000	508	0.30%
R40 000 +	402	0.24%

Link to accounts with Properties : https://drive.google.com/file/d/1aaZZY6oM2zt7j7FYSfhT16cBAFckh_yK/view?usp=drive_link

3) Applicants Linked to Registered Businesses:

- A majority of accounts (94.43%) are not linked with registered businesses
- Only 4.38% are linked to one company

- Applicants linked to registered businesses are mostly found in Collins Chabane Local Municipality, about 4 317 of them

Pivot Table: Applications with Registered Businesses

	Directorship Status / Number of Records	
Municipality	Passed	Failed
LIM345 - Collins Chabane	72,807	4,317
Other	27,483	1,213
LIM344 - Makhado	21,494	476
LIM343 - Thulamela	19,831	1,931
LIM341 - Musina	18,995	1,544

Table 3: Applications with Registered Businesses

Directorship Category	Applicants	Percentage
0 Companies	160610	94.43%
1 Companies	7450	4.38%
2 Companies	1492	0.88%
3-5 Companies	481	0.28%
6-10 Companies	48	0.03%
10+ Properties	10	0.01%

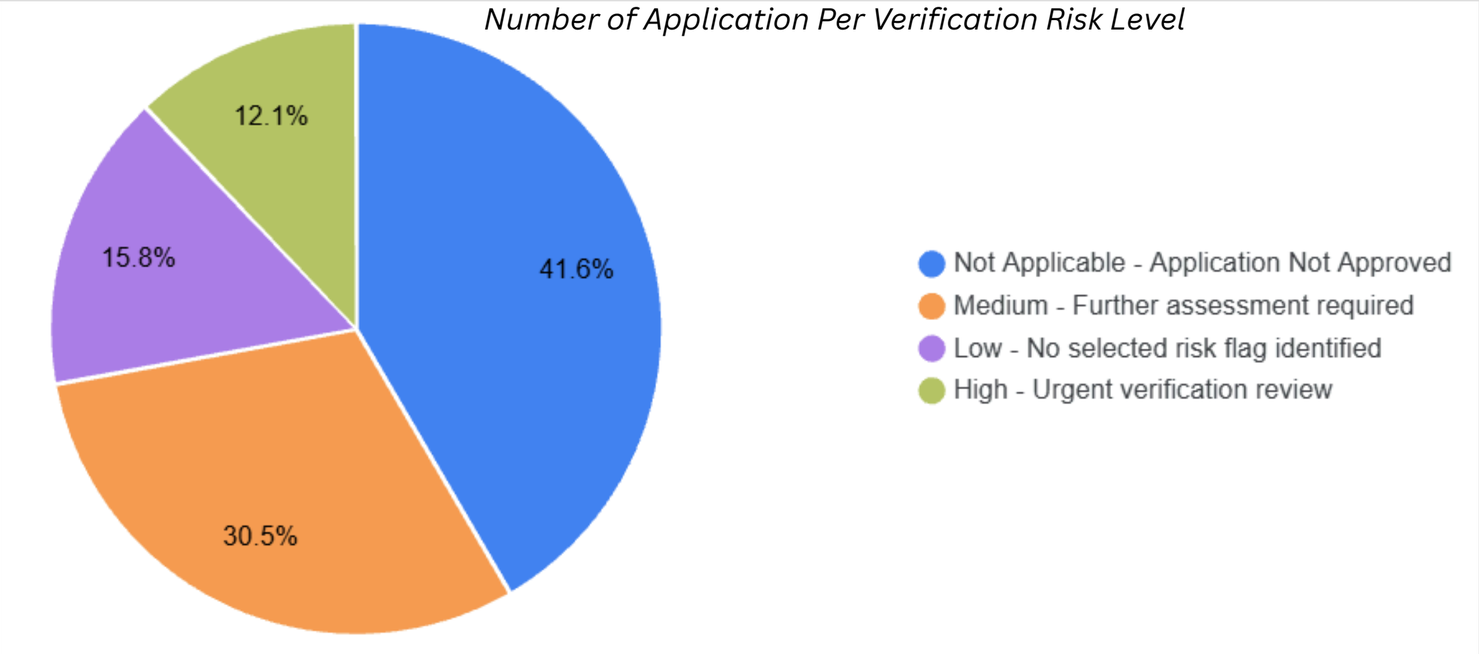
Link to accounts with Businesses : https://drive.google.com/file/d/1aaZZY6oM2zt7j7FYSfhT16cBAFckh_yK/view?usp=drive_link

4) Verification Risk Level Analysis:

- About 12.1% of the approved applications require urgent verification review
- 30.5% of the applications need further assessment
- And 15.8% have no risk flags identified for verification
- The rest of the applications (41.6%) were declined to be indigent

5) Government-Employed Applicants:

- Very few applicants are employed by the government. Here is a link to those applicants: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1kljO_uee0mvwJtC_0IH4zFxGWq88BhHe/view?usp=drive_link



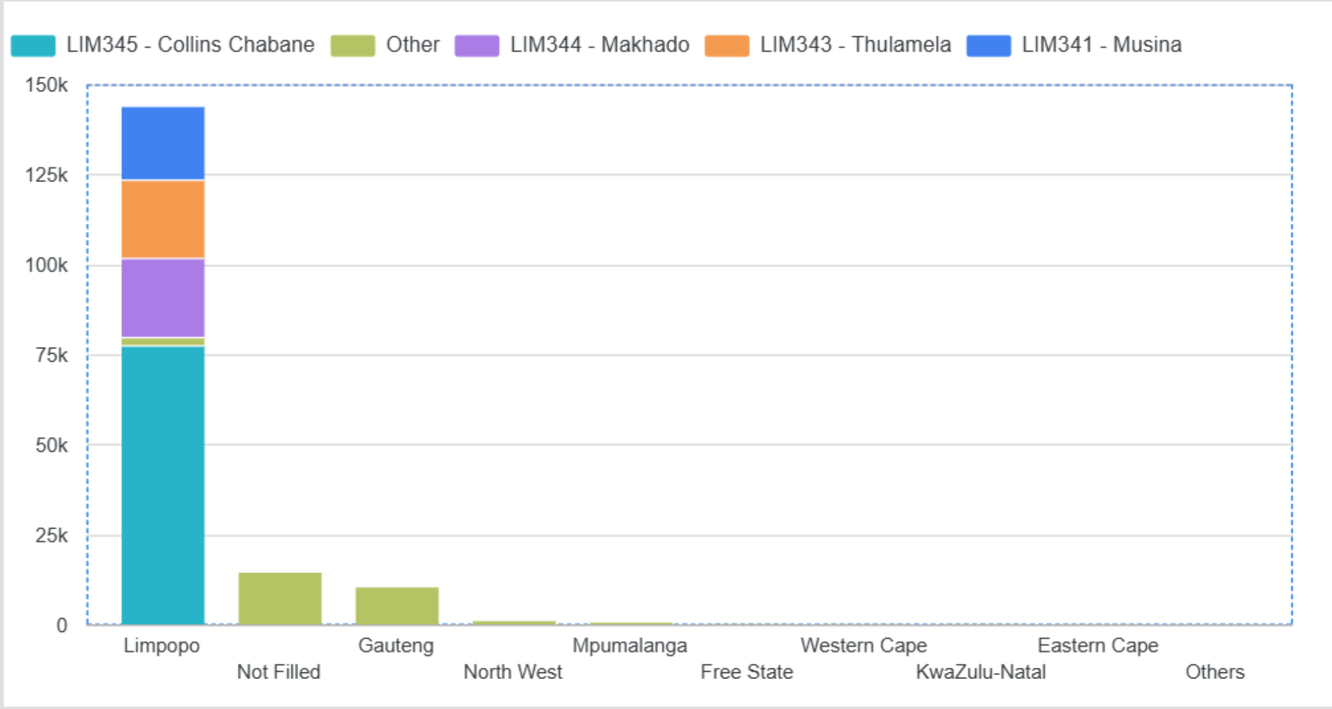
Link to accounts with Verification Risk : https://drive.google.com/file/d/1aaZZY6oM2zt7j7FYSfhT16cBAFckh_yK/view?usp=drive_link

Geographic Analysis and Heat Maps

1) Province Analysis:

- **Limpopo** province is the province with the majority number of applications, more than half of the total applications come from Limpopo, mostly on Collins Chabane Local Municipality
- **Gauteng** is the second most dominating province within Vhembe District
- The rest of the provinces have little to no records of applications

Number of Applications Per Province and Municipality



2) Indigent Application Concentration by Municipality:

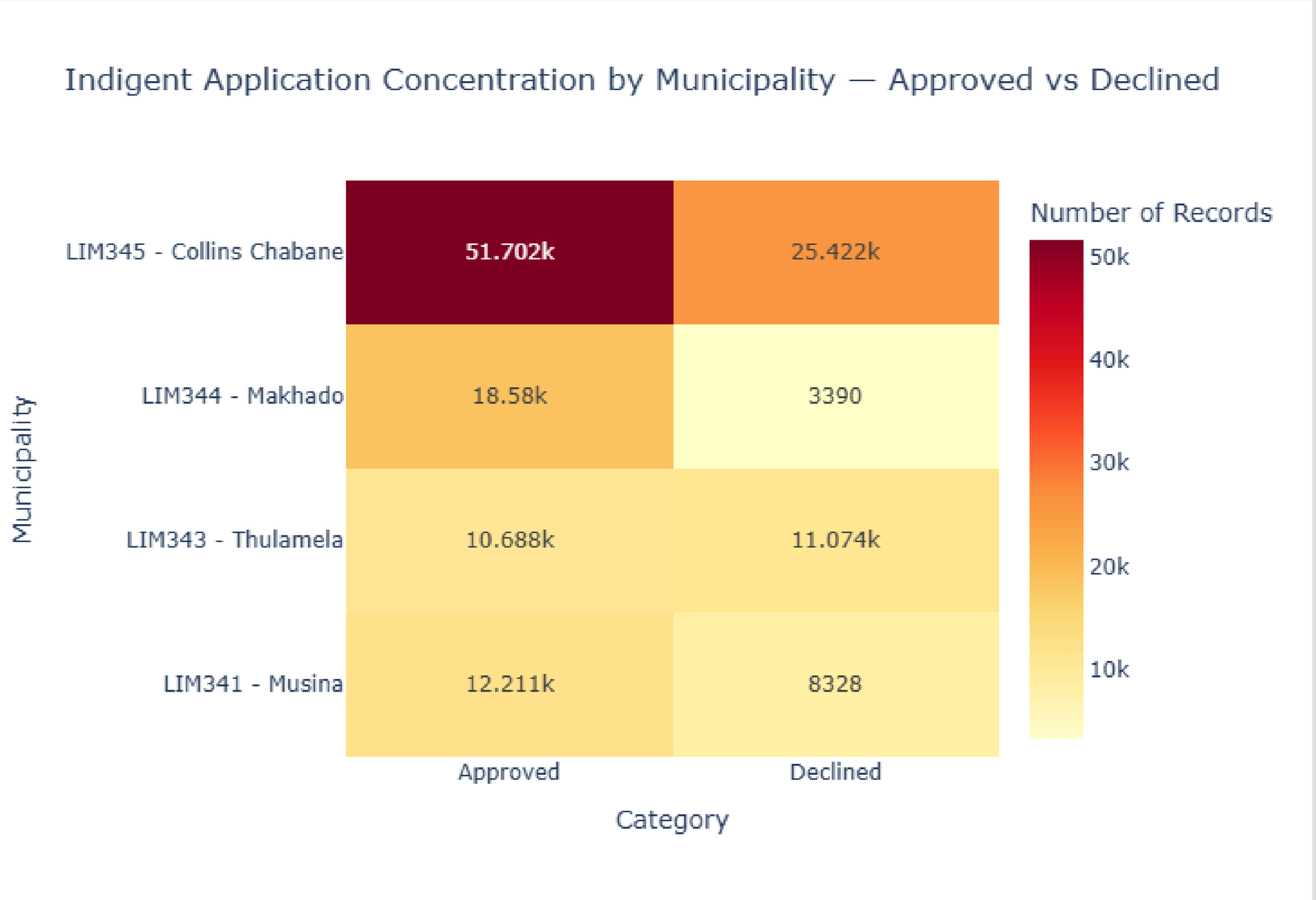
- **Collins Chabane** stands out with the highest volume of applications: over 51,700 Approved and 25,400 Declined. This suggests both substantial need and high engagement, but also a notable proportion of applicants not qualifying.

- **Makhado** shows strong approval dominance (18,580 Approved vs. 3,390 Declined) — indicating most applicants met criteria or were efficiently screened.

- **Thulamela** is unique in its balanced outcome profile: Approved (10,688) nearly matches Declined (11,074). This points to either stricter filtering or differences in applicant profiles.

- **Musina** reveals sizable engagement but with a lower total: 12,211 Approved, 8,328 Declined.

Heat Map: Indigent Outcome Concentration Per Municipality



Actionable Recommendations

1. **Direct more outreach and resources to Collins Chabane and Makhado**
   - Both municipalities show the highest numbers of approved indigent households; prioritize them for funding, support services, and community education.

2. **Investigate reasons for high declines in Collins Chabane and Thulamela**
   - Analyze declined applications for patterns (e.g., incomplete info, policy mismatches); refine criteria or application guidance to reduce unnecessary rejections.

3. **Quarterly Monitoring with Heat Maps**
   - Reproduce and review spatial heat maps each quarter to evaluate approval/decline trends, ensuring rapid response to shifting needs and optimizing targeting.

4. **Enhance Data Quality and Deduplication**
   - Deploy automated tools for removing duplicate applicants and flagging incomplete records; conduct a data quality audit every quarter to sustain register accuracy.

5. **Standardize Qualification Criteria and Data Collection**
   - Develop and enforce a district-wide indigent policy and uniform data collection template so households aren't unfairly excluded due to municipal policy differences.

6. **Strengthen Verification and Abuse Prevention**
    - Schedule annual re-verification of indigent households; cross-check with external government/social grants datasets to detect fraudulent claims or outdated registrations.

7. **Maintain a Central, Continuously Updated Digital Register**
    - Migrate to a single, secure district-wide database with logging, periodic review, and robust access control—ensuring updates are immediate and traceable.

8. **Leverage Community Partnerships**
    - Engage local NGOs, CBOs, and ward committees to support outreach, feedback, and verification processes—improving reach and trust in the program.

9. **Transparent Stakeholder Communication**
    - Publish regular progress updates, clear eligibility criteria, and contact resources for applicants and stakeholders, building trust and awareness.

Key Findings and Recommendations to Improve Data Capturing

1. **Data Quality Challenges**
   - Frequent issues include duplicate records, missing fields, inconsistent applicant IDs, and incomplete applicant information (such as missing contact details or ambiguous employer data).
   - These gaps undermine accurate indigent targeting and monitoring.

Recommendations:

   - Implement strict data validation rules at entry points (application and verification).
   - Regularly audit and deduplicate the applicant register using automated scripts.
   - Require complete fields with mandatory validation for critical attributes (ID, address, contact).

2. **Inconsistencies Across Municipalities**
   - Each municipality applies slightly different indigent qualification criteria and policies—resulting in uneven access, approval/decline rates, and potential perceptions of unfairness.

Recommendations:

   - Establish a taskforce to harmonize criteria, documentation standards, and approval workflows across all four municipalities.
   - Publish standard operating procedures (SOPs) and host staff training sessions.

3. **Standardised District Policy and Data Collection**
   - Lack of district-wide standards limits effective targeting and strategic resource allocation.

Recommendations:

   - Develop a unified Vhembe District indigent policy and standardized data collection template.
   - Centralise digital records in a single platform accessible to all municipalities, with defined governance.

4. **Preventing Benefit Abuse & Strengthening Verification**
    - Risk of abuse includes improper claims, use of outdated or false information, and duplicate registrations across municipalities.

Recommendations:

- Introduce automated cross-checks for duplicate applications, ID mismatches, and household overlaps.
- Schedule routine re-verification (e.g. annually), combined with spot audits.
- Leverage external data (e.g. SASSA, Home Affairs, credit bureaus) for enrichment and risk flagging.

5. **Improving Internal Capacity and System Utilization**
    - Variability in the use of indigent verification systems and reporting platforms hampers coordinated efforts.

Recommendations:

- Invest in regular staff training on verification tools and data management.
- Assign accountability for data quality and verification at each municipality.

6. **Proposed Approach for an Accurate and Reliable Register**
    - The register should be reliable, continuously updated, and resistant to manipulation.

Recommendations:

- Use a central digital register with built-in update tracking, change auditing, and access control.
- Enforce “single source of truth” principles, syncing verified updates across all municipalities.
- Schedule biannual district-level reviews to maintain currency and completeness.

Thank You



